VIKISEWS

CREATING A FLAT SKETCH

/MASTER OF PATTERN HACKING/

2024

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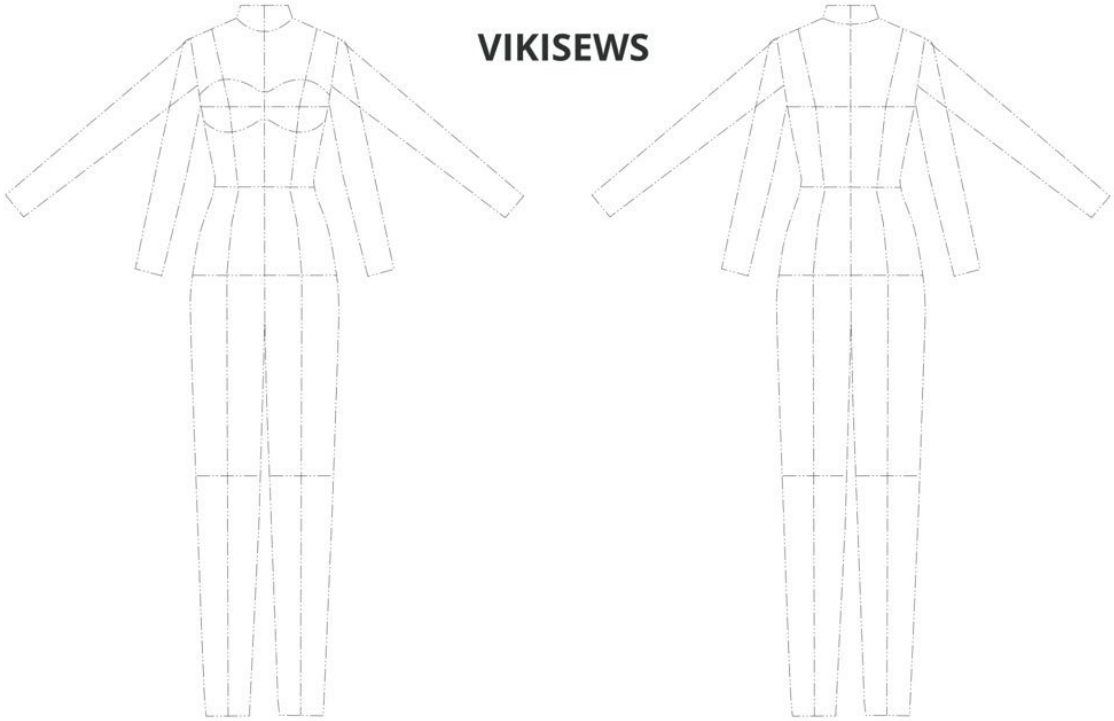
CREATING A FLAT SKETCH

Technical sketching is an essential part of the hacking process as it helps visualise a garment. A line drawing, or a flat sketch, shows the silhouette, proportions, and construction details of the garment. Crisp, accurate lines of the sketch help decide on the pattern hacking method and garment construction steps.

A flat sketch is a two-dimensional line drawing of a garment showing the construction silhouette, structural lines, decorative topstitching lines, plackets, and other elements. A sketch should be detailed and accurate, although sometimes it can be just sketchy.

When drawing a flat sketch, stick to the proportions of the figure and ensure relative proportions of all elements. Therefore, we recommend using a pre-made technical flat template.



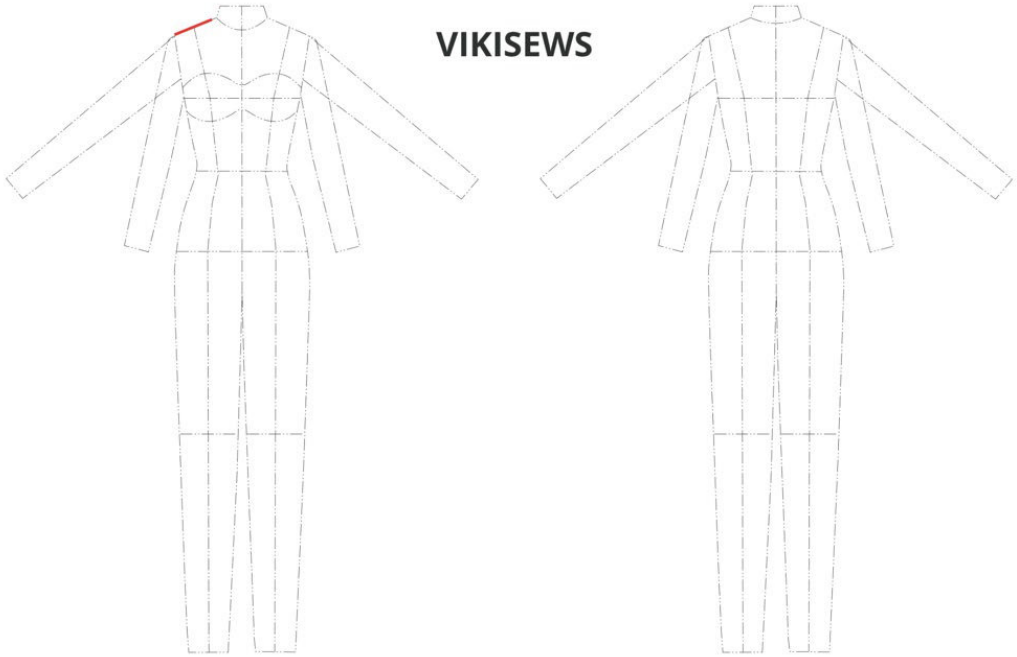
It features all basic construction lines — center line, bust line, waistline, hipline, knee line, as well as the outline of the figure and vertical structural lines. There is also a neckline and the outline of a neck to draw the collar. The bust line features a horizontal hemisphere to draw the elements of a corset.

Arms are drawn in two positions. Use the upper position to draw a grow-on sleeve or a sleeve with a low or extended armscye.

If you've made necessary calculations with full-scale values during the garment analysis, you can use the resulting values to draw the lines at a scale of 1:10. For example, the standard shoulder width is 12 cm (4 3/4"). It corresponds to the 1.2 cm (1/2") shoulder line on the flat sketch.

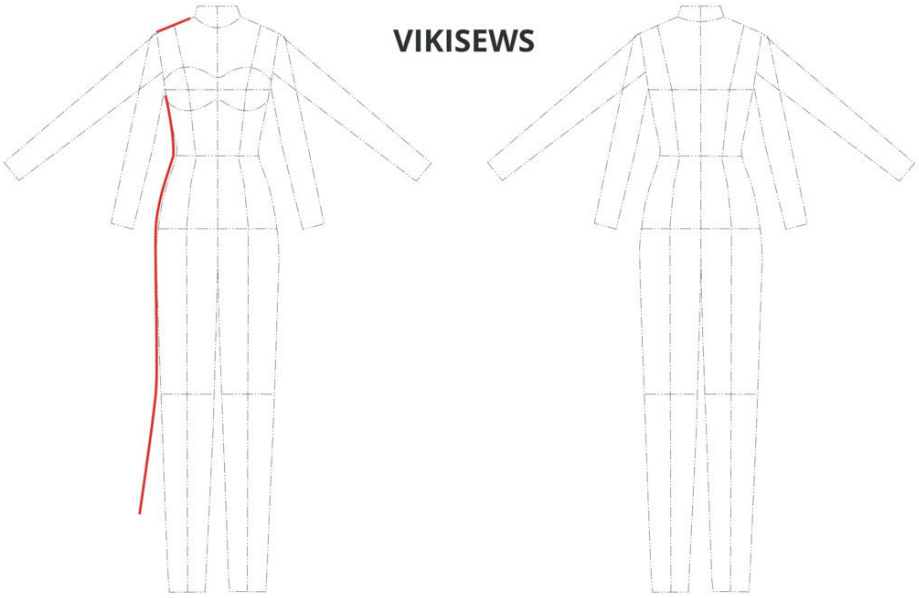
Start drawing at the top left corner and draw the left half of the sketch. After that, reflect all elements and lines to the right half. First, draw the front-view sketch, and then draw the back-view one.

Start with the shoulder line, draw it on the front-view template. When drawing the shoulder line, account for its shape, length (narrow or extended), and angle change if the garment is designed with a shoulder pad. These characteristics are identified during the design analysis.

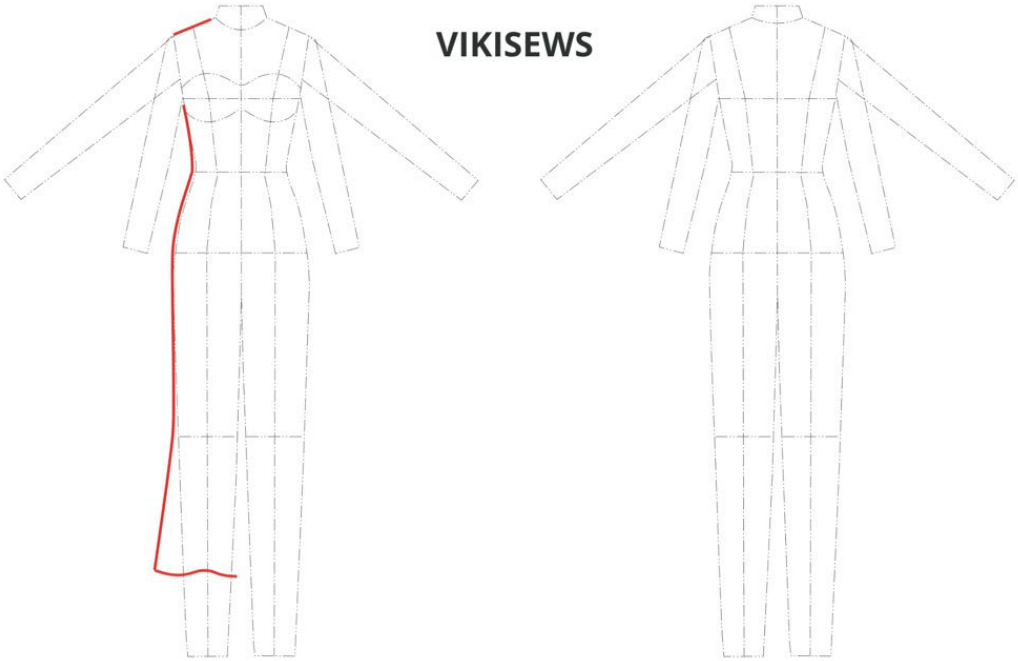


In the next step, draw the contour lines of the garment paying attention to the fit at the main construction levels: bust line, waistline, hipline, and hemline.

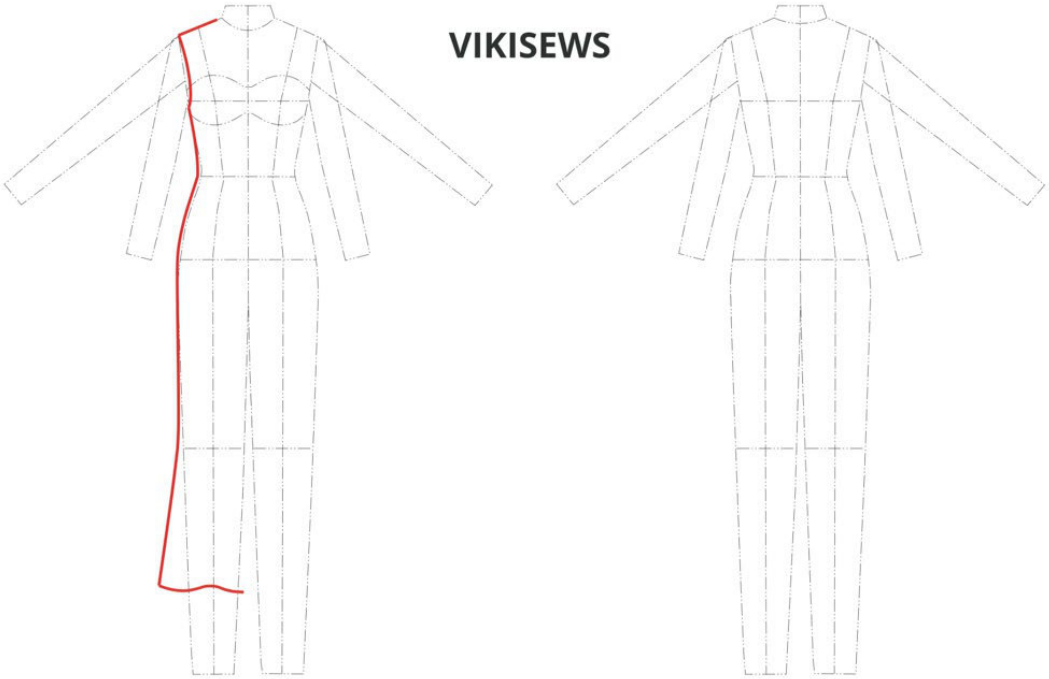
The width of the garment at the hemline is determined by the width at the hipline. The bottom part of the garment can be straight, tapered, or flared. The amount of flare depends on the garment design.



Decide on the garment length, i.e. the distance between the waistline and the hemline, and draw the hemline.



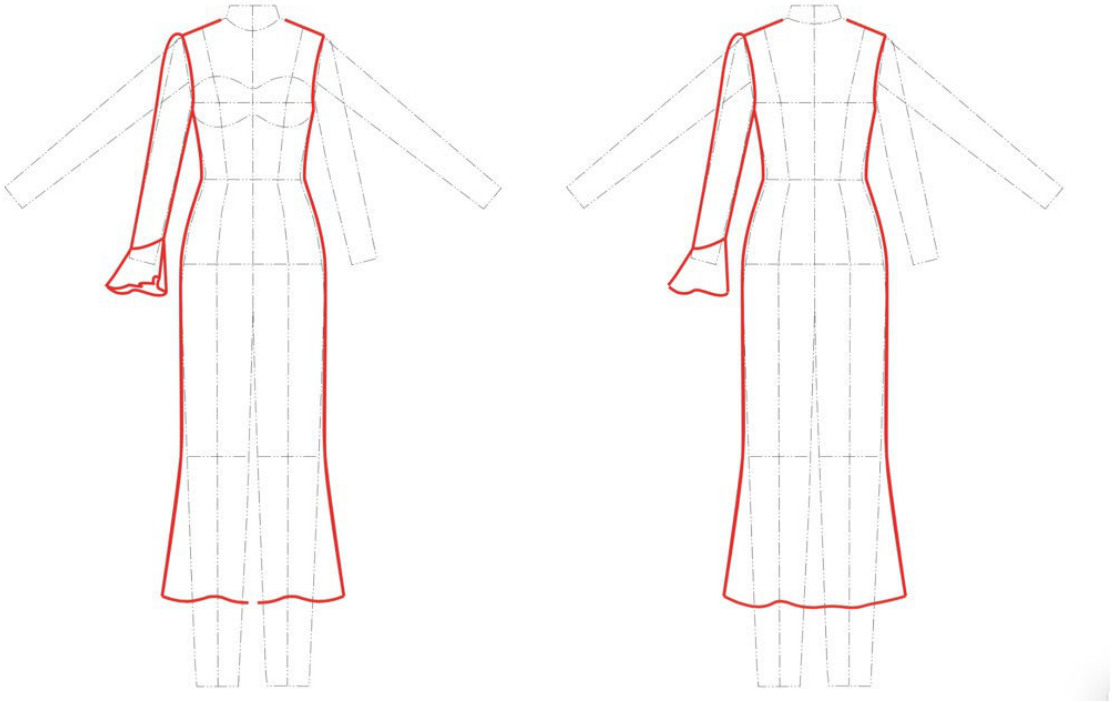
Then draw the armscye line that depends on the sleeve type. The armscye line can be low or extended as related to the bust line and side line.



Transfer all the lines symmetrically to the second half of the front-view sketch.

Then transfer the lines to the back-view sketch.

Next, proceed to drawing the sleeves. Start at the top and move downwards. Pay attention to the shoulder-arm transition, sleeve head shape, as well as the sleeve width at the lowest point of the armscye, at the elbow line, and at the sleeve hemline. Decide on the sleeve length as related to the elbow line and wrist line. Finalize the sleeve hemline with decorative elements: cuffs, gathers, flounces, etc.



After you've finished drawing the silhouette shape of the garment, draw structural and decorative elements.

At first, draw shaping elements, vertical and horizontal lines on the garment pieces. These can be various princess seams, center lines on the front and back, horizontal lines at the waistline, above or below the waistline, as well as yoke lines and other seam lines. All these elements should be positioned with respect to the construction levels (bust line, waistline, and hipline) and in proportion to each other.

Draw the neckline. Decide on the desired shape, width, and depth.

Draw the closure with respect to the center line of the garment. Pay attention to the width and shape of the center front edges, center front line, type of fasteners, placement of buttons and buttonholes, as well as the collar shape and its details.

In the final step, draw decorative elements and topstitching lines.